



AFRICA WEB3
INSTITUTE

METHODOLOGY NOTE — VERSION 1.0

Africa Digital Asset Regulatory Tracker

Source verification, classification,
peer review and corrections protocol

SECTION 1

Purpose and Scope

Core publication rule: every public regulatory claim must carry at least one traceable source, a clearly stated legal status, a verification date and accountable editorial ownership.

This methodology governs how the Africa Web3 Institute identifies, verifies, classifies, reviews and publishes developments in digital-asset regulation across African jurisdictions. It applies to the long-form tracker, website entries, research briefs and derivative social-media content.

The tracker is policy intelligence, not legal advice. It records what an authority has enacted, published, proposed, announced or implemented, while keeping factual reporting separate from AWI analysis.

SECTION 2

Editorial Principles

Principle	Application
Authority first	Primary legal and regulatory materials take precedence over commentary.
Status precision	Proposals, announcements and binding rules are never presented as equivalent.
Traceability	Readers must be able to reach the supporting document from the tracker.
Proportional review	Higher-impact claims receive deeper legal and country-level review.
Independence	Reviewers disclose relevant professional, client or commercial conflicts.
Correctability	Material amendments are logged rather than silently overwritten.

SECTION 3

Coverage and Inclusion Criteria

An item is included when it materially affects the legal status, supervision, taxation, licensing, market access, prudential treatment, consumer protection, enforcement or institutional use of digital assets in an African jurisdiction.

Include	Usually Exclude
Acts, regulations, rules, directives and gazetted notices	Routine speeches with no new policy position
Licensing, sandbox, enforcement and supervisory actions	Product launches without regulatory significance
Consultations and draft frameworks with stated deadlines	Unverified rumours or unattributed claims
Tax, AML/CFT, payments and cross-border measures	Commentary that merely repeats an existing rule

SECTION 4

Source Hierarchy and Evidence Rules

Tier	Type	Examples	Permitted Use
Tier 1	Binding primary	Gazette, statute, regulation, court decision, formal regulator instrument	Required for claims that a rule is legally in force
Tier 2	Official primary	Regulator notice, consultation, sandbox list, enforcement release, ministry publication	Sufficient for official proposals, announcements and actions
Tier 3	Authoritative secondary	Recognised law firm, professional body, academic or multilateral analysis	Corroboration or provisional reporting only
Tier 4	Media / industry	Reputable specialist media or market participant publication	Discovery lead; never sole basis for a confirmed legal claim

Minimum evidence standard: one Tier 1 or Tier 2 source for a confirmed entry. If only Tier 3 or Tier 4 evidence is available, the entry must be labelled Under Verification and cannot claim that a legal obligation is definitively in force.

SECTION 5

Regulatory Status Taxonomy

Status	Meaning	Editorial Requirement
Enacted	Formally adopted and legally binding	Effective date and binding instrument confirmed
Published	Officially issued; force or implementation may be pending	Authority page or official document confirmed
Proposed	Draft rule, bill or consultation	Do not describe obligations as final
Announced	Authority statement without published instrument	Attribute precisely to the announcing authority
Operational Guidance	Implementation instructions or supervisory expectations	Identify affected entities and commencement date
Under Verification	Credible report lacks adequate primary evidence	Publish cautiously or hold from public release

SECTION 6

Review Workflow

Stage	Required Action
1. Discovery	Researcher logs the development, jurisdiction, authority, dates and candidate sources.
2. Evidence capture	Researcher archives the primary document or stable official URL and records the access date.
3. Classification	Researcher assigns source tier, regulatory status and affected stakeholder categories.
4. Country review	A named reviewer checks the legal posture, local terminology, effective date and material omissions.
5. Editorial approval	AWI's designated editor validates the wording, evidence trail and separation of fact from analysis.
6. Publication	The approved master entry is published before any derivative social content.
7. Post-publication control	Amendments, withdrawn proposals and corrections are timestamped in the revision history.

SECTION 7

Roles and Accountability

Role	Core Duty	Accountability
Researcher	Collect evidence; draft neutral summary; complete mandatory fields	Named on internal record and full tracker entry
Country reviewer	Validate jurisdiction-specific interpretation and context	Named, with role/institution and conflict disclosure
Editorial approver	Apply methodology consistently; approve publication	AWI Policy & Research leadership
Communications	Create derivative graphics without changing the approved meaning	Source link and status label must remain visible
Technical custodian	Maintain source archive, version history and broken-link checks	Monthly integrity report

SECTION 8

Mandatory Data Fields

Field Group	Required Fields
Identification	Country; competent authority; development title; policy domain; dates announced and published; effective date; consultation deadline.
Substance	Neutral description of what changed; stakeholders affected; practical implications; separate AWI analysis.
Evidence	Primary-source URL or document reference; backup source; source tier; access date; archived copy location.
Governance	Regulatory status; confidence rating; researcher; country reviewer; editorial approver; last verified date; revision number.

SECTION 9

Confidence Rating

Rating	Threshold	Publication Treatment
High	Tier 1/2 evidence; dates and scope confirmed; country review complete	Publish as confirmed
Moderate	Official evidence exists but scope, date or interpretation remains incomplete	Publish with explicit qualification
Low	Secondary reporting only, conflicting accounts or missing official text	Under verification; normally hold from social graphics

SECTION 10

Corrections, Updates and Conflicts

Control	Requirement
Correction notice	State what changed, why, the correction date and the approving editor.
Version history	Keep superseded entries accessible and link them to the current version.
Disclosure	Reviewers disclose relevant employment, client, investment or advocacy interests.
Recusal	A conflicted reviewer may advise but cannot provide final independent approval.
Link integrity	Check primary-source links monthly and time-sensitive consultations before deadline.

SECTION 12

Publication Checklist

Check	Release Condition
Evidence	A Tier 1 or Tier 2 source supports every confirmed claim.
Status	The label matches the legal stage; the effective date is explicit or marked unknown.
Separation	Facts, implications and AWI analysis are presented distinctly.
Accountability	Researcher, country reviewer and editor are recorded.
Integrity	Links open; tracker text matches evidence; graphics match the approved entry.
Governance	Conflicts are disclosed and the next review date is assigned.

Minimum publishable unit: one primary source + one status label + one verification date + one accountable reviewer. If any element is missing, the entry remains Under Verification.

IMPORTANT NOTICE

The Africa Web3 Regulatory Tracker provides policy intelligence for informational purposes and does not constitute legal advice. Organisations should seek independent legal counsel before making compliance decisions based on tracker entries.

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